

FIFA World Cup 2026

Prediction Report

Stage: Round of 32

Run date: 2026-06-26 (report created: 2026-06-26)

Headline	Value
Title pick	Argentina (16.7%)
Most likely finalists	Argentina & Spain
Golden Boot pick	Lionel Messi (Argentina) – proj 7.3
Teams simulated	32
Monte Carlo runs	2,000

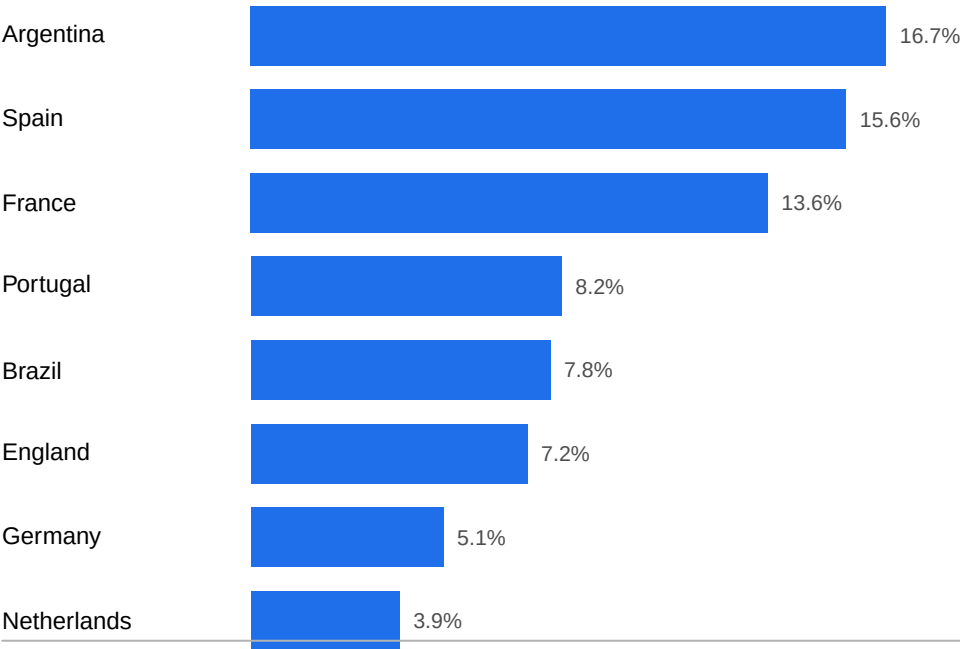
Model: ridge-shrunk Poisson (Dixon-Coles) goal model + Monte Carlo bracket simulation

Tournament Progression

As of 2026-06-26 – probabilities from 2,000 simulations

Team	R16	QF	SF	Final	Win
Argentina	72%	56%	39%	26%	16.7%
Spain	78%	58%	39%	26%	15.6%
France	75%	59%	43%	24%	13.6%
Portugal	83%	59%	29%	17%	8.2%
Brazil	71%	43%	27%	15%	7.8%
England	80%	51%	26%	14%	7.2%
Germany	72%	44%	22%	11%	5.1%
Netherlands	63%	31%	18%	8%	3.9%
Colombia	56%	30%	13%	6%	3.0%
Croatia	74%	40%	17%	7%	2.8%
Belgium	69%	32%	15%	6%	2.6%
USA	66%	24%	11%	5%	1.9%
Mexico	54%	25%	10%	4%	1.7%
Uruguay	28%	17%	9%	4%	1.6%
Switzerland	65%	25%	8%	3%	1.4%
Norway	25%	15%	7%	3%	1.1%

Title-winning probability



Round of 32 – Match Predictions

Advancer = win the tie; 90' result and likeliest score also shown

Match	Tie	Advance	90'	Score
Mexico v Canada *	Projected	Mexico (54%)	Home win	1–1 (10%)
Germany v Scotland *	Projected	Germany (72%)	Home win	1–1 (12%)
Netherlands v Morocco *	Projected	Netherlands (62%)	Home win	1–1 (13%)
Brazil v Japan *	Projected	Brazil (70%)	Home win	1–1 (12%)
England v Cape Verde *	Projected	England (81%)	Home win	2–0 (12%)
Belgium v Ghana *	Projected	Belgium (67%)	Home win	1–1 (12%)
USA v Algeria *	Projected	USA (66%)	Home win	1–1 (11%)
Spain v Austria *	Projected	Spain (79%)	Home win	2–0 (11%)
Switzerland v DR Congo *	Projected	Switzerland (63%)	Home win	1–1 (13%)
Portugal v Saudi Arabia *	Projected	Portugal (82%)	Home win	2–0 (12%)
Australia v Egypt *	Projected	Egypt (52%)	Away win	1–1 (13%)
Argentina v Uruguay *	Projected	Argentina (71%)	Home win	1–1 (12%)
France v Norway *	Projected	France (74%)	Home win	1–1 (11%)
Korea Republic v Ecuador *	Projected	Ecuador (52%)	Away win	1–1 (13%)
Colombia v Senegal *	Projected	Colombia (55%)	Home win	1–1 (13%)
Croatia v Uzbekistan *	Projected	Croatia (75%)	Home win	1–1 (11%)

* 16 tie(s) marked Projected use model-estimated participants (group stage not yet final / slot unconfirmed). Confirmed ties are locked from reported results. Update knockout_bracket.csv as matchups are confirmed and re-run.

Top–Scorer Forecast

Projected final goals = current + expected remaining

Golden Boot projection

Player	Team	Now	Exp+	Proj
Lionel Messi	Argentina	5	2.28	7.28
Kylian Mbappe	France	4	2.33	6.33
Vinicius Junior	Brazil	4	1.52	5.52
Cristiano Ronaldo	Portugal	3	1.91	4.91
Erling Haaland	Norway	4	0.89	4.89
Deniz Undav	Germany	3	1.22	4.22
Jonathan David	Canada	3	1.14	4.14
Harry Kane	England	2	2	4
Julian Alvarez	Argentina	2	1.34	3.34
Alvaro Morata	Spain	2	1.31	3.31
Romelu Lukaku	Belgium	2	1.23	3.23
Lamine Yamal	Spain	2	1.19	3.19

Top–scorer picks for Round of 32

Player	Team	Exp goals
Harry Kane	England	0.854
Cristiano Ronaldo	Portugal	0.779
Kylian Mbappe	France	0.749
Lionel Messi	Argentina	0.738
Jonathan David	Canada	0.67
Mohamed Salah	Egypt	0.636
Vinicius Junior	Brazil	0.615
Romelu Lukaku	Belgium	0.61

Recommendations & Method

How to play these predictions

STRATEGY: Back clear favourites where the model is confident (>60% advance)

to bank safe points; differentiate on tighter ties and on the Golden Boot,

where a well-placed contender on a deep team can outscore the favourite.

Model's title pick: Argentina (16.7%).

Champion pick: Argentina (16.7%). Safe R16 backers: Portugal, England,

Spain, France, Croatia, Germany.

Methodology

1. Team strength starts from Elo priors adjusted by researched form/injury notes.

2. A Dixon-Coles bivariate Poisson model turns strength into scoreline distributions;

parameters are refined by a ridge-penalised fit on observed results (shrinking to priors).

3. A Monte Carlo simulation plays out the bracket many times -> progression probabilities,

with extra time and strength-tilted penalty shootouts for knockout ties.

4. Each team's expected goals are shared among its players (form-adjusted) and weighted by

how far the team is projected to advance -> per-stage and Golden Boot scorer forecasts.

Data provenance

Verified: group draw, reported group winners, R32 anchor ties, Golden Boot tallies.

Illustrative/projected: unplayed scores and not-yet-confirmed bracket slots.

Refresh input_data/ CSVs with official data and re-run to update everything.